

Scenario 1 — Source Documents

The Budget Summary

■ **What are these?** These are the two files your AI agent had access to when it built the Q3 budget summary. The agent read both of these files before producing the document. You can refer back to them at any point during the scenario.

FILE 01 OF 02

■ Q3_BudgetMeeting_Notes_DRAFT.txt

Location: Company Drive / Q3 Planning / Meeting Notes Last modified: Friday [Date] — 2:31 PM Created by: Marcus Webb Shared with: Department Team

This is a rough set of notes taken during a budget planning meeting earlier on Friday. They cover how much the department plans to spend this quarter (July–September). Some numbers in here are still being confirmed — this is a draft, not a final document.

Field	Detail
Staff / Headcount	No changes this quarter. Nobody is being hired or let go. This number is settled and doesn't need to change.
Outside Contractors (Vendor Services)	Money paid to outside companies that do work for us. Current figure in this file: \$38,000 — but this is an OLD estimate from February, written before a major contract change happened with one of our vendors (a company called Nexus). The actual cost is higher now because the project scope got bigger. ■■ Marcus was supposed to call Nexus, find out the correct number, and send it to the team. That hasn't happened yet as of this document.
Software Subscriptions (Licenses)	What the company pays to use tools and software (think: Microsoft 365, design tools, project trackers, etc.). The \$14,500 figure is a rough estimate — the IT team still needs to confirm the actual renewal cost.
Backup / Extra Budget (Misc / Contingency)	\$5,000 set aside for unexpected costs. No changes from last quarter — this number is fine as-is.
Things still to do before numbers are final	1. Marcus calls Nexus → gets the real contractor cost → sends the updated number to the team 2. IT confirms the actual software subscription renewal cost 3. You send a clean, final summary to Priya in Finance once all the numbers above are confirmed

■■ The \$38,000 contractor figure is NOT final. The meeting notes say so clearly. The correct number was supposed to come from Marcus after his call with Nexus — it hasn't arrived yet at the time this document was last saved.

■ Q3_Budget_Tracker_LIVE.xlsx

Location: Company Drive / Finance / Budget Trackers **Last modified:** Wednesday [Date] — 11:04 AM **Created by:** Marcus Webb (maintained by Finance team) **Shared with:** Finance Team

This is a live spreadsheet the Finance team uses to track planned spending. It shows last quarter's actual costs (what was really spent) alongside this quarter's current estimates (what we think we'll spend). It's updated regularly as numbers get confirmed.

Field	Detail
What this file is for	Priya in Finance uses this to build her forecast — a prediction of how much money the department will spend this quarter. If the numbers in here are wrong, her forecast will be wrong too.
Staff / Headcount	Last quarter (Q2) actual: \$208,500 This quarter (Q3) estimate: \$210,000 Small planned increase. This number is reliable.
Outside Contractors (Vendor Services)	Last quarter (Q2) actual: \$41,200 This quarter (Q3) estimate: \$38,000 ■■ The \$38,000 is a temporary placeholder — an old number that has not been updated yet. Marcus left a note in this file (see below) saying this number must not be treated as final.
Software Subscriptions (Licenses)	Last quarter (Q2) actual: \$13,800 This quarter (Q3) estimate: \$14,500 Estimate only — IT still needs to confirm the real renewal cost.
Backup / Extra Budget (Misc / Contingency)	Last quarter (Q2) actual: \$5,000 This quarter (Q3) estimate: \$5,000 No change. This number is fine.
■■ Note left by Marcus (inside the file)	<i>"The contractor / vendor services line (\$38,000) is a temporary placeholder from the February draft budget. Do NOT treat this as the final number. It needs to be updated once I confirm the real cost after my call with Nexus." — Marcus Webb, added Wednesday</i>

■■ Both this file and the meeting notes contain clear warnings that \$38,000 is not a confirmed number. The AI agent read both of these warnings before it built the summary document.

These are fictional documents created for a simulation scenario. All names, figures, and company details are invented for testing purposes.